

The Raven's Ledger - design notes

How the folio's graphic system was designed and what each element does. The specimens on this page are drawn by the folio's own stylesheet, at the size they print, so what you see here is what is on the pages. The masthead is the one exception: it is 297 mm wide, so it is shown whole at 60 per cent and then as a detail at full size. The page prints on A4 portrait.

The measurements of record are in `docs/brand-kit.md` and the comments in `design-system/deck.css`. The reasons are in `docs/design-rationale.md`. This page is the walk-through. If the two disagree, the stylesheet wins and this page needs an entry in the ledger at the foot.

[The design process](#) [Type](#) [The house mark](#) [Rules](#) [Plates](#) [Colour](#) [Changes and updates](#)

The design process

The folio is marked on its content, not its looks. So the graphic system was designed to do one job: make twelve dense A3 pages read as one document, and let a marker find what they are looking for without being told. Every choice below came from that, in this order.

1. **Start from the brief and the marker.** NESAs sets the section names, the page limits and a 12 pt floor on type. Those are fixed. The section names are printed verbatim on every page, in the masthead dateline, so they are never only in a footer.
2. **Name it.** A ledger is a book of dated, accountable entries. That is the argument the folio makes: every feature traced to a source, every modification to a test. The raven stands for the black-on-black garment without naming a television programme in the masthead.
3. **Borrow one convention from the garment's period, and only one.** The dress is a 2022 screen costume corrected through 1905, 1926 and 1955. The pages borrow the engraved double rule under a masthead from printed ephemera of that span, and sew it: a heavy edge over a row of topstitching. Above it is identity, below it is content. Nothing else on the page is period pastiche. The grid is a modern six-column grid and the tables are plain.
4. **Two typefaces, one job each.** A fat face for the titles, because the fat faces of the 1820s to 1900s make the same historical case the pages argue. A large-bodied text face for everything a marker reads, so 12 pt is comfortably legible.
5. **Colour to navigate, never to decorate.** The garment is black. Each of the four NESAs sections gets its own colourway at the same value, so a page turn shows the section change at the masthead before a word is read. Area colours are fills and rules. They never colour text, with one measured exception.
6. **One ornament.** A nightshade flower, drawn as linework in school purple. It marks the running foot, opens and closes the two statements that frame the folio, and appears on the spine and the swing tag. Nowhere else.
7. **Measure, then write the number down.** Every width, weight and contrast ratio that the design depends on is measured in the preview and recorded in a stylesheet comment or the

brand kit, keyed to the thing it was measured on. Change the thing, re-measure, update the comment.

Type

Two families from Google Fonts, loaded by one stylesheet link. **Fraunces** at weight 900, the display face. **PT Serif** regular, bold and italic, the text face. There is no style below 12 pt anywhere on a folio page. When a page is crowded, the only fix is to cut words.

Fraunces Black, the display face

Fraunces is a variable "soft" fat face with an optical size axis. The link requests the axis range `opsz 9..144` at weight 900 only, so the browser picks the drawing for the size in use: the 38 pt wordmark gets the high-contrast display cut, and the 13 pt plate numbers get a sturdier one. It is used in exactly three places: the wordmark, the section titles, and the plate-number roundels. It is never used for a sentence.

WORDMARK, 38 PT, SLATE RULE BENEATH

The Raven's Ledger

SECTION TITLE, 19 PT

Relevance to the focus area

PLATE NUMBER, 13 PT IN A 7 MM ROUNDEL



How it works. The wordmark is `.wordmark`: Fraunces, weight 900, 38 pt, line-height 0.92, with the 30 mm slate rule under it. Section titles are `.display` with an inline 19 pt size. The roundel is `.plate-num`, a 7 mm circle filled with the chapter's field colour and ringed in ink. Filled roundels number someone else's picture. Outlined callout dots, the other numbered-circle idiom, point into the student's own drawings.

PT Serif, the text face

PT Serif has a larger body than Times at the same point size, so 12 pt PT Serif clears the NESA floor with room to spare. Every word a marker reads is set in it, including the section name in the masthead.

STANDFIRST, 16 PT, LEADING 1.4

The ledger. This folio documents a one-piece dance costume - a tea-length black dress with a detachable white collar. *Read it as an evidence trail. Each feature is numbered back to a source plate, and each making decision to a test or a fitting on the pages that follow.*

BODY, 12.5 PT, LEADING 1.3

The bodice is cut close and seamed at the waist. The skirt is four tiers of nylon tulle over a taffeta underskirt, each tier gathered to the one above at a ratio of two to one, and hemmed with 12 mm horsehair braid so the edge holds its line at performance distance.

DATELINE, 12 PT BOLD CAPS AT 0.11 EM, OVER 12 PT ITALIC

INVESTIGATION, EXPERIMENTATION AND EVALUATION

Trials & Proofs, Part IV

How it works. The lead-in word of the standfirst is Fraunces inline, so the block opens in the masthead's voice and the sentence continues in PT Serif. The dateline's line break is authored, never wrapped: only the longest section name breaks, and always at the same word. The ampersand belongs to the period titles, which are the folio's own naming. NESA section names always use "and".

Style	Face	Size and leading	Where
Wordmark	Fraunces 900	38 pt, 0.92	Masthead, all twelve pages, spine, swing tag
Section title	Fraunces 900	19 pt, 1.05	Opening display line of each page section
Plate number	Fraunces 900	13 pt in a 7 mm roundel	Source plate captions, pages 1 to 2
Standfirst, closing statement	PT Serif	16 pt, 1.4	Pages 1, 5 and 12
Body	PT Serif	12.5 pt, 1.3	Running text
Tables, captions, keys, labels, foot	PT Serif	12 pt, 1.3	Everything else
Dateline	PT Serif bold caps, italic	12 pt, 0.11 em tracking	Masthead area block

The swing tag reverse reproduced on page 7 is artwork at 1 : 1 and is the only place smaller type appears.

The house mark

One ornament for the whole set: a nightshade flower, drawn as linework in school purple. Nightshade is the character's flower and it reads as a small dark thing at arm's length, which is the whole reason it was chosen over a monogram. It is the only decorative element the folio has.



The artwork. The mark is one SVG, `assets/house-mark.svg`: five petals as an outline with a vein in each and a stamen ring, all stroked in school purple. It carries no bars of its own. The lines either side of it are always the page's CSS stitch rows, so the mark cannot draw a line that misses them. The viewBox is cropped to the drawing, 480 x 457 units, so the box is the drawing and nothing more. Anything that needs the mark links this file; there is no other copy.

Where it appears

THE ORNAMENTED RULE, 10 MM, OPENING AND CLOSING THE STATEMENTS ON PAGES 1 AND 12



THE RUNNING FOOT, 6 MM, ALL TWELVE PAGES



Major Textiles Project  Student No. 12345678

Design Inspiration  Page 1 of 12

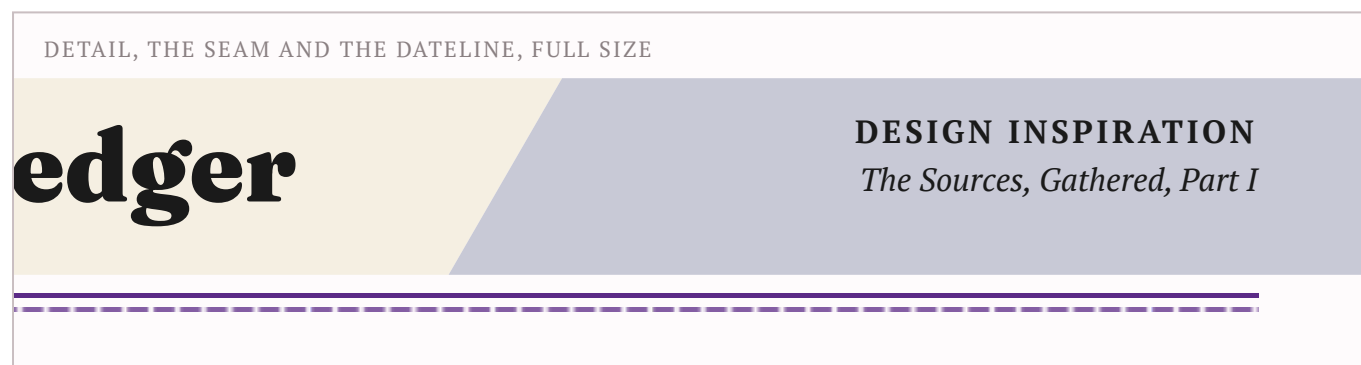
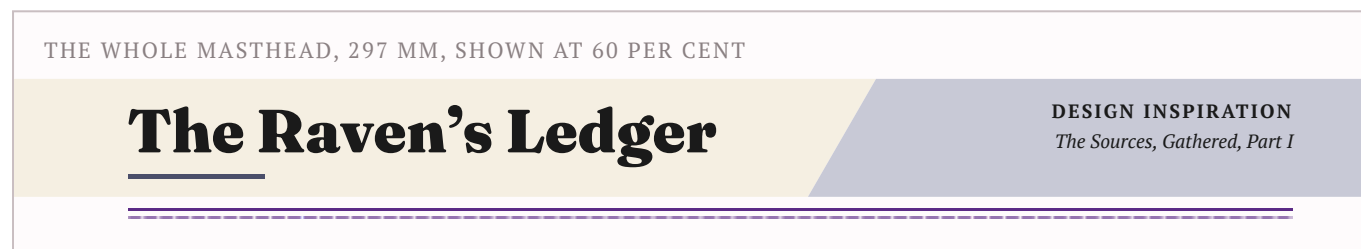
How it works. The mark is sized by its ink, not its file. `.mark-band` sets the image height from `--mark-h` and lets the width follow: 6 mm in the foot, 10 mm in the ornamented rule. The stamen ring sits 37.25 units below the centre of the 457 unit crop, so the rule lifts the image by $37.25 / 457$ of its height and the ring sits on the axis of the stitch rows either side. The foot does the same sum, then adds a drop of 0.0625 em, one pixel at 12 pt, to land

the ring on the type's optical centre. The air either side is `--mark-space`, 2.5 mm, which is 2.4 word spaces of 12 pt PT Serif: enough that the mark separates the two halves of the line rather than reading as punctuation inside it.

Where it does not appear. Not in tables, not beside headings, not on the product labels, not as a watermark. It appears in the foot, on the two statement rules, on the binder spine and on the swing tag, and nowhere else. A device used everywhere marks nothing.

Rules

The folio has three rules and each one means something. The masthead below is the real component, drawn at the page's 297 mm and shown at 60 per cent, so the double rule and the 60 degree chapter transition can be read together. The detail under it is the right-hand 180 mm at full size.



The hem. A 0.53 mm edge over a row of topstitching, 1.4 mm apart, full width of the content box, in school purple. It separates identity from content on every page, and it is read as cloth: the cream band is a panel, the heavy line its folded edge, the row beneath it the stitch that holds the hem. The stitch is one SVG tile, 2.5 mm of 0.35 mm thread with round ends and a 1 mm gap, repeated with `background-repeat: round` so every row starts and ends on a whole stitch. The edge is 0.53 mm rather than a rounder 0.4 mm because 0.4 mm is 1.51 px on a 1x screen and snapped to one row on half the pages, which collapsed the old thick-over-thin pair to a doubled hairline. The stitch is exempt from that sum: it reads by its length, 9.4 px at 1x, not by its weight.

The running foot's rule. The same stitch row, alone, over the foot on every page, and either side of the house mark on the statement rules and the swing tag.

The chapter transition. The cream band ends in a 60 degree edge after the wordmark and the area field begins on the same edge. The slant is derived from the band height, so the angle holds if the band is retuned. The area block is 122 mm wide, constrained at both

ends: wider and the wordmark is clipped, narrower and the longest section name collides with the slant. The section name's cap top lands within 0.02 mm of the wordmark's across the seam, so the two read as one line of type interrupted by the transition.

THE STUB RULE, 60 MM IN THE AREA BORDER COLOUR, UNDER AN OPENING DISPLAY LINE

Investigation, Experimentation and Evaluation

The stub rule. 60 mm by 1.1 mm in the chapter's border colour, under the opening line on pages 5 and 12. The one place a chapter colour touches a title, and it touches it as a rule, not as type.

Plates

Every source image and sketch sits in a double-ruled plate with four corner dots in the chapter colour, the way period books mounted engravings. The frame does the historical work so a mixed set of photographs reads as one considered set.

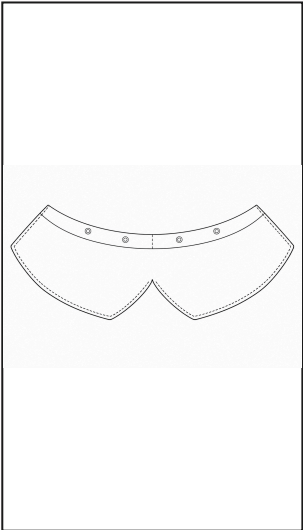
SOURCE PLATE, SLATE DOTS



SKETCH PLATE, BONE DOTS



PRODUCTION DRAWING, SINGLE BOX, NO DOTS



How it works. `.plate` is a 0.4 mm outer frame with a 0.12 mm inner frame drawn 1.8 mm inside it by a pseudo-element, and four 1.6 mm dots in the chapter's accent colour lifted above the image. Production drawings on pages 6 to 8 sit in a plain 0.3 mm box with no dots, because NESAs asks for scaled line drawings with a key and the designated second colour only, and decorative framing pulls against that.

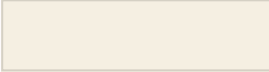
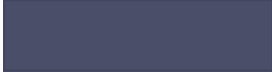
Colour

The structural colours, four section colourways, and rules for their use are shown below. Section swatches and school purple use the live stylesheet; their hex values are read from the computed style.

[Structural tokens](#) [The four colourways](#) [Token derivation](#) [Colour use](#) [Masthead transitions](#)

Structural tokens

The garment is black. The page is built from ink, paper, and cream, with two brand colours sampled from the garment itself. Slate, from the tulle where it catches light, is the rule under the wordmark. Wine, from the jet beads under warm light, is the NESA-designated second colour for pattern modifications on pages 6 to 8. Slate and Wine arrive as props so the preview can re-sample them; the values shown are the defaults. School purple colours the house mark and its divider lines.

Ink  #1A1A1A Text, engraving rules, drawings	Paper  #FEFBFC Page background	Cream  #F5EFE2 Masthead band	Slate  #4A4E69 Rule under the wordmark. Prop slate
Wine  #8C3B4A Pattern modifications. Prop wine	School purple  #5B2A86 House mark and divider lines		

The four colourways

Each NESA section is a chapter, and each chapter has a colourway held at the same value as the other three so the four read as one family. A page turn shows the section change at the masthead before a word is read. The five tokens in each are field, border, accent, tint, and emph; the swatches below are filled from the `--area-*` tokens the pages themselves use.

Area I - The Sources, Gathered

Design Inspiration · Slate · pages 1 to 2

Field --sources-field	#C8C9D6	
Border --sources-border	#7C7F9E	

Accent --sources-accent	#6A6D86	
Tint --sources-tint	#EFF0F3	
Emph --sources-emph	#5A5C70 6.38 : 1 on paper	

Area II - The Designs, Weighed

Visual Design Development · Bone · pages 3 to 5

Field --designs-field	#DAD2C7	
Border --designs-border	#A6957A	
Accent --designs-accent	#8D7F69	
Tint --designs-tint	#F4F2EF	
Emph --designs-emph	#766B59 5.08 : 1 on paper	

Area III - The Making

Manufacturing Specification · Ash · pages 6 to 8

Field --making-field	#C9D4DA	
Border --making-border	#7F98A8	
Accent --making-accent	#6D818E	
Tint --making-tint	#F0F3F5	
Emph --making-emph	#5C6C77 5.28 : 1 on paper	

Area IV - Trials & Proofs

Investigation, Experimentation and Evaluation · Wine · pages 9 to 12

Field --trials-field	#D8C1C6	
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Border <code>--trials-border</code>	<code>#A26B78</code>	
Accent <code>--trials-accent</code>	<code>#8A5C67</code>	
Tint <code>--trials-tint</code>	<code>#F4EDEF</code>	
Emph <code>--trials-emph</code>	<code>#744F58</code> 6.80 : 1 on paper	

The contrast ratios are measured against paper `#FEFBFC` and are written in the stylesheet beside each emph value. If an accent is ever re-sampled, re-derive its emph and re-measure.

How the tokens are derived

One colour is chosen per chapter, the border. The other four are made from it, so a colourway is one decision and four arithmetic steps.

- **Border** is the chosen colour at full strength.
- **Field** is the border mixed 42 per cent over white.
- **Tint** is the border mixed 12 per cent over white.
- **Accent** is the border mixed as 82 per cent border and 18 per cent ink.
- **Emph** is the accent mixed as 80 per cent accent and 20 per cent ink: `color-mix(in srgb, <accent> 80%, #1A1A1A)`.

The accents are graphic tones and measure under 4.5 : 1 on paper. The design uses 4.5 : 1 as its minimum for coloured text on paper. 80 per cent is the mix at which all four emph values clear 4.5 : 1 with margin while the hue is still plainly the chapter's. Every value is written into `deck.css` as a literal, not as a `color-mix()` call, so it survives without that function and so a marker's contrast check lands on a number that is in the file.

Where colour may go

Area tokens are fill and rule colours, never text colours. Text over field, tint, or a border-coloured table header is always ink. Emph is the only token that may colour type, and its one use is the last clause of the closing statement on page 12. Recheck text contrast whenever these colours change.

The tulle, the collar, the closure, the band, the raw edges and the way each tier is gathered and set were all decided by an experiment on these pages. That is the argument this ledger was kept to make.

The one exception, as it sets. A closing clause in Wine emph, 16 pt, at 6.80 : 1 on paper. It reads in the chapter's own colour, the same family as the rule stub, the table headings and the plate dots around it, rather than introducing a hue the folio uses nowhere else.

Per page, the area class recolours exactly these components and nothing else.

Component	Token	Where
Masthead chapter-transition block	field	All twelve pages
Table header rows	border	Wherever a table sets
Table cells	tint	Wherever a table sets
Plate corner dots	accent	Pages 1 to 5
Section-title stub rules	border	Pages 5 and 12
Closing clause	emph	Page 12 only

Kept in brand colours, not area colours: the slate rule under the wordmark, the house mark and its divider lines in school purple, and the wine that marks pattern modifications on pages 6 to 8. Production drawings and pattern pieces stay pure ink linework.

The masthead transitions

The cream band ends after the wordmark in a 60 degree clipped edge and the area field begins on that same edge, so the two fills meet along one line with no paper between. The field is the only place a chapter colour touches the masthead. These four are the real

`.masthead2`, one per area, drawn by `deck.css` at 297 mm and shown at 60 per cent.

The Raven’s Ledger

DESIGN INSPIRATION
The Sources, Gathered, Part I

The Raven’s Ledger

VISUAL DESIGN DEVELOPMENT
The Designs, Weighed, Part I

The Raven’s Ledger

MANUFACTURING SPECIFICATION
The Making, Part I

The Raven’s Ledger

INVESTIGATION, EXPERIMENTATION
AND EVALUATION
Trials & Proofs, Part I

Slate, Bone, Ash, Wine. The dateline is ink on field on every page. The section name is NESAs, verbatim; only the longest one breaks, and its break is authored. The ampersand in Trials & Proofs is the folio's own title and is not NESAs-facing.

Changes and updates

The design system is not finished. This is the ledger of what changed after the sections above were written, newest first. When you change an element, add an entry here and update the section it belongs to. One entry per change: the date, what changed, why, and which files carry it.

24 SEPTEMBER 2026

Design notes fit A4 portrait.

The page was a 1160 px centred column with 297 mm masthead specimens, too wide to print even on A3 landscape. The column is now 180 mm, 15 mm off the start edge, which is A4 portrait less its margins. The mastheads are drawn at 297 mm and zoomed to 60 per cent, 178.2 mm, and the Rules section adds the right-hand 180 mm at full size so the rule weights can still be judged 1:1. The standfirst, the ornamented rule and the foot take the column width instead of 257 mm.

<design-system/meta/design-process.html>

22 SEPTEMBER 2026

Page 7 labels carry the care symbols again and match the label sheet.

The three label boxes on page 7 had dropped to words only, and their fibre lines and care notes had drifted from the sewn labels. The boxes are now the label sheet's own markup: wordmark at 15 pt, piece, fibre, the five symbols at 6.5 mm, the note and the origin at 12 pt. Measured on the preview the block runs 328 to 390 mm and the content box closes at 400 mm, so the row fits without cutting copy.

<design-system/Folio Deck.dc.html>, <design-system/deck.css>, <design-system/product-labels.css>, <docs/production-items.md>

22 SEPTEMBER 2026

Product labels print both ways, on two sheets.

The mirror prop asked the printer to remember a setting the sheet could only report after the fact. The run is now printed twice: sheet 1 as it reads, for a printable fabric sheet or a label printer, and sheet 2 mirrored, for iron-on transfer paper. Each sheet fixes its own orientation and says so in its banner, and the notes sheet presents the two approaches side by side rather than three routes and a switch.

<design-system/Product Labels.dc.html>, <design-system/product-labels.css>, <scripts/preview.ps1>, <docs/production-items.md>, <docs/print-specifications.md>

21 SEPTEMBER 2026

Product labels share one layout and carry care as symbols.

The three sewn labels ran different care sentences and the sheet assumed iron-on transfer, with the notes pointing at a swing tag the folio no longer shows. Every label now runs wordmark, piece, fibre, the five care symbols, a one-line note and the origin. The symbols are the swing tag's drawing at 5.5 mm on the label and 6.5 mm on page 7, and the label cell is the finished 71 x 48 mm patch, so the sheet prints as it reads for a fabric sheet or a label printer and mirrors only for transfer paper.

design-system/Product Labels.dc.html, design-system/product-labels.css, design-system/Folio Deck.dc.html, scripts/preview.ps1, docs/production-items.md

20 SEPTEMBER 2026

Full colour notes moved into the Colour chapter.

The swatches, token derivation, contrast ratios, component mapping, and four masthead specimens now sit here. School purple is included. The separate colour page and preview option have been removed.

design-system/meta/design-process.html, scripts/preview.ps1, docs/brand-kit.md

19 SEPTEMBER 2026

Colour exploration replaced by the colour design notes page.

The swatch sheet in explorations still called the areas Rose, Sage and Marigold, had no emph token and drew its masthead at screen scale from its own copy of the values. The new page links deck.css, fills every chip from the live token and reads the hex back from the computed style, so it cannot disagree with the pages. The masthead exploration was one rejected option and is gone with the folder.

design-system/meta/colour-notes.html, scripts/preview.ps1, docs/brand-kit.md, AGENTS.md

19 SEPTEMBER 2026

Source lineage reversed and the overskirt made the invention.

The folio argued from three museum dresses to a 2022 character. The brief runs the other way: the 2022 dance dress is the source and the three periods are the corrections. Pages 1 to 5 now start from that dress at face value. The detachable collar was too small a change to carry the creativity criterion, so the tiered skirt is now a separate overskirt on a hooked band and the costume converts between the dance and the school scene. Tiers regraded 18, 26, 34 cm to cover the 68 cm skirt; Experiment 8 now tests the band closure. Plate 1 is the 2022 dress and the historical plates moved to 2 to 4.

design-system/Folio Deck.dc.html, design-system/assets/plates.json, design-system/assets/i1 to i4 and i7, design-system/Product Labels.dc.html, design-system/Swing Tag.dc.html, docs/design-rationale.md

19 SEPTEMBER 2026

Page 1 source plates cut to a 2:3 frame.

The four generated dress images are 1024 x 1536 px. In the 84mm plate the inner rectangle measured 56.1 x 90.4mm, so the image sat 3mm short at top and bottom. The plate content height is now 77.8mm, which gives an inner rectangle of 56.1 x 84.2mm and saves 6.2mm on the page.

[design-system/Folio Deck.dc.html](#), [design-system/assets/plates.json](#)

19 SEPTEMBER 2026

Design notes page added to the preview build.

The reasons behind the graphic system lived in three places: the brand kit, the design rationale and the stylesheet comments. None of them showed the elements. This page draws them with the live stylesheet so the explanation and the artwork cannot drift apart.

[design-system/meta/design-process.html](#), [scripts/preview.ps1](#)